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California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Central Valley Region

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Edmund G. Brown Jr.
Governor

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Mr. Stan Craig, Assistant Southern Region Chief
State of California Natural Resources Agency
Department of Forestry and Fire Protection
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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY

**WATER QUALITY ORDER NO. 97-10-DWQ, GENERAL WASTE DISCHARGE
REQUIREMENTS FOR DISCHARGES TO LAND BY SMALL DOMESTIC WASTEWATER
TREATMENT SYSTEMS, CALIFORNIA DEPARTMENT OF FORESTRY AND FIRE
PROTECTION, BASELINE CONSERVATION CAMP, WASTE WATER TREATMENT
FACILITY, TUOLUMNE COUNTY**

The Baseline Conservation Camp currently discharges wastewater to a Wastewater Treatment Facility (WWTF) comprised of a septic tank, ponds, and spray fields. Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order No. 91-014 regulates the discharge. The WDRs are obsolete, inconsistent with current plans and policies of the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region (Central Valley Water Board), and need to be updated.

On 28 April 2011, Central Valley Water Board staff received your letter requesting coverage of the discharge under *Water Quality Order No. 97-10-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for Discharges to Land by Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems* (hereafter General Order).

Based on the findings of the original WDRs, recent information from self-monitoring reports and information in your request, the discharge meets the conditions of the General Order. The discharge is hereby covered under *Water Quality Order No. 97-10-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for Discharges to Land by Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems*. The facility is assigned Notice of Applicability (NOA) No. 97-10-DWQ-R5073.

The following requirements contained within the General Order apply to the subject discharge:

1. All Section A Prohibitions,
2. Section B Requirement Nos. 1.a-1.d, 2.a-2.c, and 6.a-6.d;
3. All Section C Ground Water and Surface Water Limitations;

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4. Section D Provision Nos. 1.a-1.v and 2.a-2.b; and
5. All Attachment B Standard Provisions and Reporting for Waste Discharge Requirements.

The following sections of Attachment A, Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) No. 97-10-DWQ, apply to the subject discharge:

1. Septic Tank Monitoring,
2. Pond/Basin Monitoring, and
3. Reporting.

LOCATION

The Department of Forestry and Fire Protection operates the WWTF in Section 22, T1N, R13E, MDB&M. The site is adjacent to Peoria Flat Road near Jamestown and is a Level IV detention facility owned by the State of California.

The WWTF is in the San Joaquin River Basin. The *Water Quality Control Plan for the Sacramento and San Joaquin River Basins, Fourth Edition* (hereafter Basin Plan), designates beneficial uses, establishes water quality objectives, and contains implementation programs and policies to achieve water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin.

DESCRIPTION

Currently the facility generates an average of 20,000 gallons per day of domestic waste from a maximum of 130 inmates and about 25 California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation and Cal Fire staff assigned to the conservation camp. The full-time facility is active year round and while the inmate population is usually stable, a higher flow occurs during the winter months due to inmate crews and staff staying on location as well as infiltration and inflow into the collection and disposal system.

The WWTF is comprised of a fiberglass septic tank, a fiberglass lift station with duplex pumps that deliver effluent to the treatment and storage ponds. Pumps then dispense effluent from the ponds to spray fields covering roughly two acres. The WWTF has an emergency generator with automatic transfer switch that will operate the system pumps in the event of a commercial utility power loss.

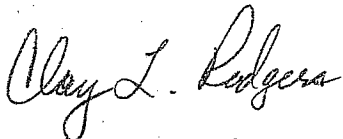
There are no natural surface waters in close proximity to the WWTF. The beneficial uses for the groundwaters of the State are: municipal and domestic supply, industrial service supply, industrial process supply, and agricultural supply.

FACILITY-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

In addition to the above requirements, the Department of Forestry and Fire Protection must comply with the following:

1. Discharge of wastewater at a location or in a manner different from that described above is prohibited.
2. The WWTF shall be operated in accordance with the requirements contained in the General Order.
3. The waste discharge shall not enter surface waters or surface water drainage courses.
4. The Department of Forestry and Fire Protection shall submit the required annual fee (as specified in the annual billing issued by the State Water Resources Control Board) until the NOA is officially terminated.
5. Failure to abide by the conditions of the General Order and this letter authorizing applicability, including its monitoring and reporting requirements, could result in enforcement actions as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

If you have any questions regarding this NOA, please contact Dale Harvey at (559) 445-6190.



for Pamela C. Creedon
Executive Officer

Enclosures: Water Quality Order No. 97-10-DWQ